

Activity Guide — middle / module-01- what-is-iks

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 01 — Vedanga Matching Game

Module: What is IKS? (Middle) · **Day:** 3 · **Time:** 15 min

Goal

In pairs, students match the 6 Vedangas (Sanskrit names) to their functions in a memory-card game.

Materials per pair

- 12 cards: 6 with Sanskrit names, 6 with English function descriptions

Cards (cut from printout)

Names: Śikṣā · Kalpa · Vyākaraṇa · Nirukta · Chandas · Jyotiṣa

Functions: Phonetics · Ritual procedure · Grammar · Etymology · Prosody · Astronomy & astrology

Rules

1. Shuffle all 12 cards. Lay face-down in a 3×4 grid.
2. On your turn, flip 2 cards.
3. If they match (name + function), keep the pair.
4. If not, flip face-down. Other player goes.
5. Most pairs wins.

Discussion (5 min after)

- Which match was hardest to remember?
- Why might “Jyotiṣa” combine astronomy AND astrology?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add 4 sub-cards with examples (e.g. “Pāṇini” matches “Vyākaraṇa”).
- **Tier down:** Play with only 3 pairs (Vyākaraṇa, Jyotiṣa, Kalpa).

Project Brief

Project Brief — Module 1 (Middle)

Type: 5-minute presentation · **Marks:** 20 · **Due:** Day 10

What you'll do

Pick ONE strand of Indian Knowledge Systems. Give a 5-minute presentation that includes:

1. **Named practitioner** — a real person (Aryabhata, Pāṇini, Suśruta, Mādhava, Bhāskara II, Kauṭilya, Caraka, Bharata, ...).
2. **Specific claim** — not “X is great” but “X did Y in year Z.”
3. **One source** — primary (verse, theorem, text) or scholarly (Plofker, Wujastyk, Pollock).
4. **Modern parallel or use** — what does this connect to today?
5. **Honest limitation** — what did the tradition NOT do?

Format

- 5 min spoken + 1 min Q&A.
- Slides optional; if used, 3–5 slides max.
- Handout welcome.

Rubric (see [rubric.md](#))

Conceptual accuracy (×2) · Source quality (×1.5) · Specific claim (×1.5) · Honest limitation (×1) · Communication (×1).

Self-reflection (submit on Day 10)

In 4–5 sentences: 1. What did you set out to research? 2. What surprised you? 3. With 3 more days, what would you research deeper?